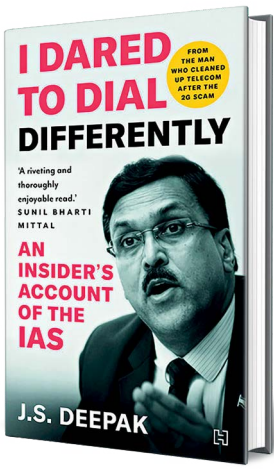
uld be on your reading list



SPECTACLE STATE How Hindutva Shapes Feeling and Culture
By Brahma Prakash
HARPERCOLLINS INDIA
₹599; 304 pages

SOFT POWER

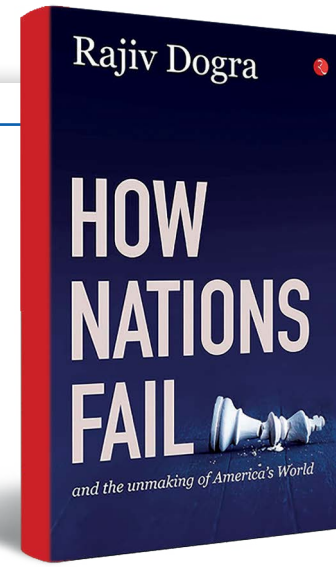
This incisive book by cultural theorist Brahma Prakash examines how political power manifests as spectacle in India. As someone who teaches theatre and performance studies at the School of Arts and Aesthetics, Jawaharlal Nehru University, he brings a unique perspective to the subject, looking beyond political praxis and other means of nation-making, training his sights instead on religious processions, music, festivals and so on.



I DARED TO DIAL DIFFERENTLY
An Insider's Account of the IAS
By J.S. Deepak
HACHETTE WESTLAND/CONTEXT
₹799; 344 pages

CIVIL LINES

J.S. Deepak's candid memoir of a four-decade-long career in the IAS—during which he also served as Secretary, Telecom and IT, and as India's ambassador to the WTO—offers a ringside view of the institution that runs the country. The highlight of Deepak's career was designing and conducting India's first-ever 3G spectrum auctions.



HOW NATIONS FAIL AND THE UNMAKING OF AMERICA'S WORLD
By Rajiv Dogra
RUPA
₹895; 343 pages

CENTRE CAN'T HOLD

Why do civilisations disappear? Why do mighty empires crumble? Why do nations collapse? Former Indian diplomat Rajiv Dogra sets out to address these intriguing questions. He dips into world history for answers, sees a world order in transition at present, and also peeks into the future.

Law and Order

This is an insider's account of the triumphs and travails of law enforcement, intelligence-gathering and national security in India by former IPS officer Yashovardhan Azad, who also served as central information commissioner after retirement. A highlight is a 2004 mission to Pakistan to assess risks on the ground prior to a tour by the Indian cricket team.



POLICING THE REPUBLIC
An Inside View of How India Fights Corruption and Crime, and Protects Rights
By Yashovardhan Azad
BLOOMSBURY
₹699; 312 pages

—Compiled by Amit Dixit